MODULE 30 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

How the Exam's Questions Are Written

The anatomy of an item, what each qualifier asks, the two readings of choose-two, ordering items, and the distractor families.

DOMAIN All EXAM WEIGHT Technique MODULE 30 of 33

admin@sthithapragna.com

Every stem hides a decider. Find it before you read the options.

admin@sthithapragna.com

What the official sources say

- **Sixty items, 120 minutes:** two minutes per item on average.
- **Two item types:** multiple choice, and scenario-based multiple response. Each item states how many to select.
- **Pass on the total:** scaled 720 on 100 to 1,000. Domain percentages are feedback only.
- **The guide's samples ask** for "the most appropriate action" and the choice that "best fits the task".
- **Not stated anywhere official:** guessing penalties, partial credit, or a review screen.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Plan as if a blank scores nothing and a pair must be fully right.

The anatomy of an item

PART	WHAT IT HOLDS	WHAT TO DO WITH IT
Situation	Who, where, and what they want	Note the role and the goal
Decider	The constraint that rules options out	Find it, and hold on to it
Ask	The qualifier: best, first, before, most likely	Read it first
Options	One fits every constraint; three fit some	Eliminate, then compare the last two

THE SIGNAL

Deciders are usually policy, volume, audience, sensitivity or timing.

Answering a single-answer item

01
Ask
Read the last line first.

02
Decider
Find the constraint that matters.

03
Predict
Say the answer before looking.

04
Eliminate
Name each wrong option's family.

05
Compare
Test the last two on the decider.

06
Commit
Choose, and move on.

ON THE EXAM

Predicting first stops a well-written distractor from setting the agenda.

What each qualifier really asks

THE WORD	WHAT IT ASKS
"Most appropriate" or "best"	Several work; pick the one meeting every constraint, in proportion
"First"	The step nothing else can start without; usually framing
"Before X"	X's prerequisites only; ignore anything after X
"Next"	The step after the one the stem says is done
"Most likely root cause"	The cause that explains every symptom, and the timing
"Which two"	Read each option on its own before pairing

THE TIEBREAKER

"Best" admits that other options would work. That is what makes them tempting.

Choose-two: two readings

"EACH ANSWER IS PART OF THE SOLUTION"

Two halves of one fix

- Both are needed together
- Often two different steps or controls
- The pair covers the whole problem
- Avoid two that do the same job

"EACH ANSWER IS A COMPLETE SOLUTION"

Two separate fixes

- Either one alone would work
- Test each option by itself
- The two may be alike in kind
- Reject anything that half-solves it

THE TIEBREAKER

The instruction line tells you whether to build a pair or find two winners.

Choose-two technique

- **Judge each option alone:** true or false against the stem, before thinking about pairs.
- **Assume no partial credit:** nothing official promises it, so both must be right.
- **Three look right?** The decider removes one. It is usually the over-engineered option.
- **Only one looks right?** Re-read the stem for a second constraint you skipped.
- **Never pick two that contradict each other,** such as "remove the data" and "upload it all".

> THE SIGNAL
>
> Five options, two right, three wrong. Find the three wrong ones and the pair is left.

Ordering items: three shapes

SHAPE	SHARE OF PRACTICE ITEMS	METHOD
Put five steps in order	10%	Anchor first and last, place dependencies, read it back
Which step comes first	7%	Find the framing step: purpose, audience, criteria, impact
Which two come before X	6%	List what X depends on; discard what follows X

ON THE EXAM

Frame before acting. Document findings before deciding, and the decision after.

The distractor families

FAMILY	SOUNDS LIKE	WHY IT FAILS
Absolutes	"always", "never", "no human needed"	Real controls are proportionate
Over-engineering	Build an app; top model for everything	Effort out of proportion
Skipping a step	Draft now, send now, roll out now	Acts before framing or checking
Deferring everything	Ban it, wait, escalate it all	Avoids the decision asked for
Trusting the model	Ask Claude to confirm itself	A model cannot verify itself
Right step, wrong time	A good action too early or late	Order is part of the answer

THE SIGNAL

Name the family, and the option usually falls away.

What right answers tend to look like

- **Proportionate:** the lightest approach that fully meets the need.
- **Built-in first:** a Claude feature before a custom build.
- **Framed:** purpose, audience and criteria settled before acting.
- **Verified:** checked against a primary source, not the model's word.
- **Human where it matters:** review with authority when stakes are high.
- **Policy-aware:** data classified and minimised before it goes in.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> Tendencies, not rules. The stem's decider always wins.

Reading a stem, one part at a time

PART	IN THIS STEM
Situation	An analyst is comparing three long supplier contracts
Purpose	A recommendation to the board next month
Decider	"Quality matters far more than cost or speed"
Ask	"Which model best fits the task?"
Prediction	Deep reasoning over long documents, quality first: Opus

THE SIGNAL

Predict before you look. Then find the option that matches your prediction.

Pacing the two hours

- **Checkpoints:** item 20 by about 35 minutes, item 40 by about 70. That leaves time to revisit.
- **First pass:** answer every item, even when unsure, and note the ones to revisit.
- **Review:** if the exam offers a review screen, use it. The official pages do not describe one.
- **Changing answers:** only for a new reason found in the stem, never for a feeling.
- **Nothing blank:** no penalty is mentioned anywhere official, and a blank cannot score.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> A stuck item gets a best guess and a note, not five more minutes.

Traps in the reader, not the options

- **Reading the options first,** so a distractor frames the question.
- **Answering from your own workplace** instead of from the stem.
- **Answering the question you expected,** not the one in front of you.
- **Choosing the newest or most powerful** option by default.
- **Adding facts** the stem never gave you.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> The stem is the whole world. If it is not in the stem, it is not in the question.

> For months, Halden's weekly incident summaries, built in a Project, included a risks section. For the last two weeks, it has been missing.
>
> Nobody has edited the Project. Last month the sites moved to a new incident form, where the risks field is optional and usually left blank.

What is the most likely root cause?

A The Project instructions have become too long for Claude to follow

B The Project holds too many files for Claude to read them all

C The summaries need a more capable model

D The new form leaves the risks field blank, so the input has no risks to summarise

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most likely root cause?

A The Project instructions have become too long for Claude to follow

Unchanged instructions cannot explain the timing.

B The Project holds too many files for Claude to read them all

Nothing was added; the timing does not fit.

C The summaries need a more capable model

Over-engineering: the same model worked for months.

D The new form leaves the risks field blank, so the input has no risks to summarise

Explains the symptom and when it started.

THE SIGNAL

Root cause: what changed just before the symptom started.

> Halden's facilities director is preparing a tender response for a hospital cleaning contract, due in three weeks.
>
> Several teams will contribute sections, and she wants Claude to help throughout.

What should she do FIRST?

A Ask Claude to draft the full response from the tender pack

B Build a Project holding every tender response Halden has ever written

C Agree the scoring criteria, the audience and the sections the response must cover

D Send the pack to each team and let them use Claude however they like

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should she do FIRST?

A Ask Claude to draft the full response from the tender pack

Skipping a step: drafting before framing.

B Build a Project holding every tender response Halden has ever written

Over-engineering, and premature: knowledge before purpose.

C Agree the scoring criteria, the audience and the sections the response must cover

Framing: nothing else can start well without it.

D Send the pack to each team and let them use Claude however they like

Deferring: no shared criteria or structure.

THE SIGNAL

"First" almost always means framing: purpose, audience, criteria.

> A Halden audit lead pastes the same cleaning-standards document into every audit chat.
>
> She wants to stop doing that, without losing access to the standards.

Which two actions would each solve this on their own? Each correct answer presents a complete solution. Choose two.

A. Ask Claude to store the whole document in Memory

B. Create a Project for audit chats, with the standards uploaded as knowledge

C. Shorten the document so that pasting it is quicker

D. Switch to a more capable model, which will know Halden's standards

E. Connect Google Drive, so Claude reads the standards from there

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two actions would each solve this on their own? Each correct answer presents a complete solution. Choose two.

A Ask Claude to store the whole document in Memory

Memory keeps brief facts, not reference documents.

B Create a Project for audit chats, with the standards uploaded as knowledge

Complete: the standards are there in every audit chat.

C Shorten the document so that pasting it is quicker

Still pasting: half a fix at best.

D Switch to a more capable model, which will know Halden's standards

No model knows a company's internal standards.

E Connect Google Drive, so Claude reads the standards from there

Complete: Claude reads the live document on request.

THE SIGNAL

"Complete solution": test each option alone. Either B or E would do.

Halden is introducing Claude to help draft replies to client complaints.

(1) Pilot with one team and measure the results.

(2) Define the problem and how success will be measured.

(3) Check what complaint data may be shared, against policy.

(4) Roll out to the other teams, with guidance.

(5) Review the pilot and adjust the prompts and Project.

What is the correct order?

A 3, 2, 1, 4, 5

B 2, 1, 3, 5, 4

C 2, 3, 1, 4, 5

D 2, 3, 1, 5, 4

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the correct order?

A 3, 2, 1, 4, 5

Checks data before knowing what the problem is.

B 2, 1, 3, 5, 4

Pilots on complaint data before the policy check.

C 2, 3, 1, 4, 5

Rolls out before reviewing the pilot.

D 2, 3, 1, 5, 4

Frame, check data, pilot, review, then roll out.

THE SIGNAL

Anchor first and last, then place each dependency.

> A Halden HR officer has a Claude-drafted letter responding to an employee's flexible working request.
>
> The letter states a specific statutory deadline for the company's decision.

What is the most appropriate action before the letter is sent?

A Ask Claude to confirm that the deadline it cited is correct

B Stop using Claude for any letter from the HR team

C Check the deadline against official government guidance, and have a qualified HR adviser approve the letter

D Send it, because Claude cited a specific statutory deadline

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most appropriate action before the letter is sent?

A Ask Claude to confirm that the deadline it cited is correct

Trusting the model: it cannot verify itself.

B Stop using Claude for any letter from the HR team

Absolute, and deferring: bans a useful tool.

C Check the deadline against official government guidance, and have a qualified HR adviser approve the letter

Primary source, plus qualified human review.

D Send it, because Claude cited a specific statutory deadline

Specific is not the same as correct.

THE SIGNAL

Legal claims go to a primary source, and a person who answers for them.

> Halden's office manager has three PDF quotes from venues for the staff awards night.
>
> She needs a one-off comparison on price, capacity and accessibility by Friday.

Which approach best fits the task?

A. Ask a developer to build an app on the API that compares quotes automatically

B. Upload the three quotes to a chat and ask for a comparison table against her criteria

C. Set up a shared Project with a Skill and a Drive connector for venue quotes

D. Use Research to gather online reviews of each venue

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which approach best fits the task?

A Ask a developer to build an app on the API that compares quotes automatically

Over-engineering, and outside the associate's role.

B Upload the three quotes to a chat and ask for a comparison table against her criteria

Proportionate: a one-off task in one chat.

C Set up a shared Project with a Skill and a Drive connector for venue quotes

Over-engineering: nothing needs to persist.

D Use Research to gather online reviews of each venue

A different task: she asked to compare the quotes.

THE SIGNAL

"One-off" is the decider. The lightest approach that fully meets it wins.

In five lines

- **Find the decider** and read the ask before you read the options.
- **Qualifiers:** best admits others work; first means framing; before means prerequisites only.
- **Choose-two:** "part of the solution" builds a pair; "a complete solution" tests each alone.
- **Families:** absolutes, over-engineering, skipped steps, deferral, trusting the model, wrong time.
- **Pace:** two minutes an item, nothing blank, change answers only for a reason.

COMING UP

Next: practice exam one. Twenty new questions across all seven domains.